GRADE 1 ELA

Reading Foundations and Phonics

Multiple-Choice Question Bank

150 questions total
50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Includes letter recognition, letter sounds, short and long vowels, CVC words, consonant blends and digraphs, rhyming, syllables, decoding, sound manipulation, and early reading strategies.

Student copy followed by a separate answer key.

Easy Questions (50)

Choose the best answer for each question.

1. Which letter comes after B in the alphabet?

A. A
B. D
C. C
D. E

2. Which letter comes before G?

A. I
B. H
C. F
D. E

3. Which one is a lowercase letter?

A. T
B. b
C. R
D. M

4. Which one is an uppercase letter?

A. d
B. g
C. P
D. q

5. Which letter makes the first sound in sun?

A. s
B. m
C. p
D. t

6. Which letter makes the first sound in dog?

A. d
B. f
C. b
D. g

7. Which letter makes the first sound in fish?

A. s
B. h
C. f
D. v

8. Which letter makes the last sound in map?

A. p
B. m
C. t
D. a

9. Which word begins with the same sound as ball?

A. fish
B. sun
C. bat
D. cat

10. Which letter is a vowel?

A. r
B. e
C. t
D. b

11. Which word has the short a sound?

A. cake
B. day
C. cat
D. rain

12. Which word has the short i sound?

A. five
B. sit
C. bike
D. time

13. Which word has the short o sound?

A. hot
B. home
C. go
D. boat

14. Which word spells /c/ /a/ /t/?

A. cut
B. cat
C. cap
D. cot

15. Which word spells /p/ /e/ /n/?

A. pan
B. pin
C. pun
D. pen

16. Which word has the same vowel sound as bed?

A. ride
B. road
C. red
D. rude

17. Choose the word that completes: The ___ can hop. (f-r-o-g)

A. from
B. free
C. frog
D. flag

18. Which word begins with /m/?

A. lake
B. kite
C. moon
D. nose

19. Which word ends with /t/?

A. sit
B. see
C. sun
D. sip

20. Which word rhymes with cat?

A. cup
B. hat
C. can
D. cut

21. Which word rhymes with log?

A. dig
B. leg
C. lip
D. dog

22. Which word rhymes with hen?

A. pon
B. pin
C. pen
D. pan

23. How many syllables are in cat?

A. 2
B. 4
C. 1
D. 3

24. How many syllables are in rabbit?

A. 4
B. 2
C. 1
D. 3

25. Which word has two syllables?

A. hand
B. fish
C. sunset
D. dog

26. Which letter comes first alphabetically?

A. d
B. c
C. b
D. a

27. Which letter is a consonant?

A. o
B. i
C. m
D. a

28. Which word has the short e sound?

A. feet
B. seed
C. bed
D. tree

29. Which word has the short u sound?

A. cube
B. bus
C. cute
D. use

30. Which word begins with the same sound as kite?

A. shoe
B. thin
C. king
D. city

31. Which word begins with the same sound as ship?

A. sip
B. sock
C. chip
D. shop

32. Which letter makes the first sound in van?

A. w
B. b
C. f
D. v

33. Which letter makes the final sound in bed?

A. t
B. b
C. e
D. d

34. Which word has the letter a making a short sound?

A. jam
B. cake
C. late
D. name

35. Which word is made of three sounds /h/ /e/ /n/?

A. hen
B. then
C. hench
D. when

36. Which word rhymes with fox?

A. fix
B. fax
C. box
D. fog

37. Which word rhymes with bug?

A. hug
B. bog
C. bag
D. big

38. Which word starts with the same sound as zebra?

A. cat
B. zip
C. van
D. ship

39. Which word ends with the same sound as fish?

A. dish
B. fit
C. fan
D. fin

40. Which letter is between L and N?

A. O
B. M
C. K
D. P

41. What is the first letter in the word sun?

A. n
B. u
C. s
D. t

42. Which word is a CVC word?

A. map
B. play
C. ship
D. tree

43. Which word has the short a sound?

A. mine
B. moon
C. man
D. mean

44. Which word has the short i sound?

A. loop
B. leap
C. lope
D. lip

45. Which word begins like pencil?

A. cake
B. dog
C. ten
D. pig

46. Which word begins like rabbit?

A. rain
B. goat
C. fish
D. lion

47. How many syllables are in banana?

A. 2
B. 4
C. 1
D. 3

48. Which word has one syllable?

A. apple
B. open
C. tiger
D. book

49. Which letter comes after X?

A. Y
B. W
C. Z
D. V

50. Which letter comes before D?

A. C
B. F
C. E
D. B

Medium Questions (50)

Choose the best answer for each question.

1. Which word begins with the blend /st/?

A. thin
B. stop
C. chip
D. shop

2. Which word begins with /bl/?

A. black
B. flag
C. clap
D. glad

3. Which word begins with /tr/?

A. train
B. brain
C. drain
D. chain

4. Which word ends with the blend /nd/?

A. ham
B. hat
C. hand
D. has

5. Which word has the blend /gr/?

A. queen
B. clean
C. green
D. seen

6. Which word begins with the digraph sh?

A. ship
B. chip
C. sip
D. tip

7. Which word begins with ch?

A. care
B. there
C. chair
D. share

8. Which word has th at the beginning?

A. tin
B. win
C. fin
D. thin

9. Which word begins with wh?

A. ten
B. then
C. den
D. when

10. In which word does ch make one sound?

A. clap
B. chop
C. cart
D. crab

11. Which word has the long a sound spelled ai?

A. tan
B. trap
C. top
D. train

12. Which word has the long e sound spelled ee?

A. grain
B. green
C. grub
D. grin

13. Which word has a long i sound?

A. bike
B. fin
C. sit
D. bit

14. Which word has a long o sound?

A. hope
B. not
C. hot
D. hop

15. Which word has a silent e that makes the vowel long?

A. cap
B. can
C. cat
D. cape

16. Which word changes from a short vowel to a long vowel with silent e?

A. kit → kite
B. man → men
C. sit → sat
D. hop → hot

17. Which word belongs to the -ake word family?

A. book
B. bake
C. back
D. buck

18. Which word belongs to the -ight word family?

A. net
B. nut
C. night
D. note

19. Which word belongs to the -ump word family?

A. jump
B. jeep
C. joke
D. jam

20. Which word is made by blending /f/ /l/ /a/ /g/?

A. frog
B. flat
C. flog
D. flag

21. Which word is made by blending /s/ /n/ /a/ /p/?

A. snap
B. slap
C. span
D. snip

22. Which set of sounds matches the word crab?

A. /c/ /r/ /b/
B. /c/ /a/ /b/
C. /c/ /r/ /a/ /b/
D. /c/ /r/ /a/

23. Which set of sounds matches the word ship?

A. /s/ /i/ /p/
B. /sh/ /p/
C. /s/ /h/ /i/ /p/
D. /sh/ /i/ /p/

24. How many syllables are in computer?

A. 2
B. 1
C. 4
D. 3

25. Which word has three syllables?

A. pencil
B. elephant
C. rabbit
D. sunshine

26. Which word has a short vowel sound?

A. these
B. plane
C. pet
D. cube

27. Which word has a long e sound?

A. red
B. feet
C. bed
D. fell

28. Which word starts and ends with the same sounds as map?

A. mop
B. mad
C. tap
D. cap

29. Which word is spelled correctly for /ch/ /i/ /p/?

A. cheap
B. chip
C. chop
D. ship

30. Which word has the same vowel sound as tune?

A. cube
B. cot
C. cut
D. cup

31. Which word contains a blend in the middle?

A. basket
B. baby
C. baker
D. basic

32. Which word has sh at the end?

A. with
B. wine
C. wide
D. wish

33. Which word has the vowel team oa?

A. boot
B. boat
C. bite
D. bat

34. Which word has the vowel team ay?

A. play
B. plum
C. plot
D. plan

35. Which word has the /ar/ sound?

A. perk
B. park
C. pick
D. pack

36. Which word has the /or/ sound?

A. steam
B. stem
C. storm
D. stamp

37. Which word is different because it begins with a digraph?

A. then
B. thin
C. tree
D. that

38. Which word has a consonant blend at the beginning?

A. phone
B. whale
C. frog
D. ship

39. Which word rhymes with bright?

A. brought
B. flight
C. bring
D. bread

40. Change the /m/ in mat to /s/. What word do you make?

A. sit
B. set
C. sat
D. sad

41. Change the /p/ in pin to /t/. What word do you make?

A. tip
B. ten
C. tin
D. tan

42. Change the /c/ in cap to /m/. What word do you make?

A. man
B. mat
C. map
D. mop

43. Say smile without /s/. What remains?

A. mile
B. file
C. smile
D. slime

44. Say clap without /c/. What remains?

A. clip
B. slap
C. lap
D. cap

45. Which word would come first in a dictionary?

A. flag
B. fan
C. fish
D. frog

46. Which word completes the sentence? I ___ see a bird.

A. cone
B. can
C. coin
D. cane

47. Which word matches the sounds /b/ /r/ /u/ /sh/?

A. brash
B. brunch
C. brush
D. bush

48. Which word has the same vowel pattern as rain?

A. tail
B. ring
C. run
D. ran

49. When reading aloud, what helps a reader sound smooth and clear?

A. Read each word carefully and group words meaningfully
B. Read as fast as possible
C. Skip words that are hard
D. Guess every unfamiliar word

50. Which word begins with the blend /sp/?

A. top
B. cot
C. shot
D. spot

Hard Questions (50)

Choose the best answer for each question.

1. Which word has a beginning blend and a silent-e pattern?

A. slip
B. slide
C. slush
D. ship

2. Which word contains both a consonant blend and a vowel team?

A. ship
B. thin
C. cake
D. street

3. Which word begins with a three-letter consonant blend?

A. splash
B. ship
C. clap
D. train

4. Which word contains a digraph and a consonant blend?

A. thrift
B. crash
C. thin
D. float

5. Which word has the same vowel sound and spelling pattern as team?

A. head
B. dream
C. bread
D. great

6. Which word has the same vowel sound as bread?

A. bead
B. seed
C. head
D. seat

7. Which word has the same long-o vowel team sound as boat?

A. boot
B. coach
C. but
D. bought

8. Which word has the long a sound spelled with a-e?

A. shade
B. shod
C. shed
D. shad

9. Which word has the same r-controlled vowel sound as bird?

A. born
B. bear
C. barn
D. shirt

10. Which word has the same vowel sound as turn?

A. barn
B. burn
C. brain
D. born

11. Which word has two syllables and a closed first syllable?

A. napkin
B. music
C. robot
D. paper

12. Which word is correctly divided into syllables?

A. ra-bbit
B. r-abbit
C. rabb-it
D. rab-bit

13. Which word is divided correctly between its two syllables?

A. su-nset
B. sun-set
C. s-unset
D. sunse-t

14. How many syllables are in fantastic?

A. 2
B. 4
C. 3
D. 5

15. Which word has three syllables?

A. sunlight
B. remember
C. rabbit
D. basket

16. Change the /b/ in black to /c/. Which word do you make?

A. cluck
B. clack
C. clock
D. click

17. Change the /f/ in flat to /p/. Which word do you make?

A. plant
B. plat
C. plate
D. plot

18. Change the /sl/ in slip to /cl/. Which word do you make?

A. clop
B. clap
C. clip
D. clue

19. Take away /t/ from the beginning of train. What remains?

A. train
B. brain
C. rain
D. grain

20. Take away /s/ from the beginning of splash. What remains?

A. slash
B. splash
C. plash
D. flash

21. How many sounds are in the word ship?

A. 3
B. 4
C. 2
D. 5

22. How many sounds are in the word stretch?

A. 6
B. 4
C. 7
D. 5

23. How many sounds are in the word box?

A. 4
B. 3
C. 5
D. 2

24. Which word has four sounds?

A. chat
B. flag
C. sheep
D. sun

25. Which word matches /s/ /t/ /r/ /ee/ /t/?

A. street
B. sweet
C. streak
D. seat

26. Which word matches /b/ /r/ /■/ /k/?

A. break
B. brick
C. brook
D. brake

27. Which word has a different vowel sound from the others?

A. bead
B. team
C. seat
D. bread

28. Which word has a different beginning sound pattern from the others?

A. ship
B. shut
C. thin
D. phone

29. Which word does not belong with the others because it has a long vowel?

A. hope
B. hog
C. hot
D. hop

30. Choose the word that correctly completes the sentence: The puppy will ___ on the rug. (rest / roast)

A. rest
B. riest
C. roast
D. rust

31. Which word completes the sentence and has a long i sound? The kite can ___.

A. flit
B. flat
C. fly
D. flip

32. Which word completes the sentence with the /ch/ sound at the end? Please eat your lun__.

A. ck
B. th
C. sh
D. ch

33. Which word has a prefix added to a base word?

A. unhappy
B. rabbit
C. sunset
D. basket

34. Which word has an ending that changes it to mean 'more than one'?

A. catch
B. cats
C. cat
D. cart

35. Which word has the same base word as jumping?

A. jumpery
B. jumperful
C. jumpying
D. jumped

36. A student reads 'ship' as 'sip.' Which phonics feature should the student review?

A. The long-a vowel
B. The sh digraph
C. The -ing ending
D. The silent-e pattern

37. A student reads 'hop' as 'hope.' Which feature explains the difference?

A. The h changes the vowel
B. The p is silent in hope
C. The silent e makes the o long
D. The word hope has two syllables

38. Which word contains a vowel team that represents a long e sound?

A. chest
B. chiefly
C. chew
D. chief

39. Which word has the /oi/ sound?

A. keen
B. cone
C. can
D. coin

40. Which word has the /ou/ sound as in cloud?

A. shut
B. shout
C. sheet
D. shot

41. Which word ends with a consonant digraph?

A. brand
B. brisk
C. brush
D. brick

42. Which word has the /ng/ sound at the end?

A. rinse
B. rind
C. ride
D. ring

43. Which word has its stress and syllables represented correctly as two spoken parts?

A. picn-ic
B. p-i-cnic
C. pi-cnic
D. pic-nic

44. Change the /ch/ in chin to /th/. Which word do you make?

A. thin
B. tin
C. shin
D. then

45. Change the final /t/ in bet to /d/. Which word do you make?

A. bed
B. bad
C. bat
D. bid

46. Change the /a/ in clap to /i/. Which word do you make?

A. clop
B. clup
C. clap
D. clip

47. Which strategy is best when you meet an unfamiliar decodable word?

A. Skip the word every time
B. Guess from the picture only
C. Look at the letters, say the sounds, and blend them
D. Say a familiar word that starts the same

48. Which word contains a long vowel, a beginning blend, and a silent e?

A. cheek
B. chain
C. crash
D. crane

49. Which word contains a short vowel and a final consonant blend?

A. mildly
B. mile
C. milk
D. mine

50. Which word has a vowel team and ends with a consonant blend?

A. train
B. team
C. boat
D. toast

Answer Key

Answers are grouped by difficulty. Each answer includes the correct option and a brief skill label for review.

Easy

1. C. C — Letter recognition
2. C. F — Letter recognition
3. B. b — Letter recognition
4. C. P — Letter recognition
5. A. s — Letter sounds
6. A. d — Letter sounds
7. C. f — Letter sounds
8. A. p — Letter sounds
9. C. bat — Letter sounds
10. B. e — Vowels
11. C. cat — Vowels
12. B. sit — Vowels
13. A. hot — Vowels
14. B. cat — CVC words
15. D. pen — CVC words
16. C. red — CVC words
17. C. frog — CVC words
18. C. moon — Beginning sounds
19. A. sit — Ending sounds
20. B. hat — Rhyming
21. D. dog — Rhyming
22. C. pen — Rhyming
23. C. 1 — Syllables
24. B. 2 — Syllables
25. C. sunset — Syllables
26. D. a — Alphabetical order
27. C. m — Consonants
28. C. bed — Short vowels
29. B. bus — Short vowels
30. C. king — Word reading
31. D. shop — Word reading
32. D. v — Letter sounds
33. D. d — Letter sounds
34. A. jam — Vowel identification
35. A. hen — CVC words
36. C. box — Rhyming
37. A. hug — Rhyming
38. B. zip — Beginning sounds
39. A. dish — Ending sounds

40. B. M — Letter names
41. C. s — Alphabetical order
42. A. map — Consonant-vowel-consonant
43. C. man — Short vowels
44. D. lip — Short vowels
45. D. pig — Sound matching
46. A. rain — Sound matching
47. D. 3 — Syllables
48. D. book — Syllables
49. A. Y — Letter recognition
50. A. C — Letter recognition

Medium

1. B. stop — Consonant blends
2. A. black — Consonant blends
3. A. train — Consonant blends
4. C. hand — Consonant blends
5. C. green — Consonant blends
6. A. ship — Consonant digraphs
7. C. chair — Consonant digraphs
8. D. thin — Consonant digraphs
9. D. when — Consonant digraphs
10. B. chop — Consonant digraphs
11. D. train — Vowel teams
12. B. green — Vowel teams
13. A. bike — Long vowels
14. A. hope — Long vowels
15. D. cape — Silent e
16. A. kit → kite — Silent e
17. B. bake — Word families
18. C. night — Word families
19. A. jump — Word families
20. D. flag — Blending sounds
21. A. snap — Blending sounds
22. C. /c/ /r/ /a/ /b/ — Segmenting sounds
23. D. /sh/ /i/ /p/ — Segmenting sounds
24. D. 3 — Syllables
25. B. elephant — Syllables
26. C. pet — Short and long vowels
27. B. feet — Short and long vowels
28. A. mop — Beginning and ending sounds
29. B. chip — Decoding
30. A. cube — Decoding
31. A. basket — Consonant blends

32. D. wish — Consonant digraphs
33. B. boat — Vowel teams
34. A. play — Vowel teams
35. B. park — R-controlled vowels
36. C. storm — R-controlled vowels
37. C. tree — Word reading
38. C. frog — Word reading
39. B. flight — Word families
40. C. sat — Sound substitution
41. C. tin — Sound substitution
42. C. map — Sound substitution
43. A. mile — Sound deletion
44. C. lap — Sound deletion
45. B. fan — Alphabetic decoding
46. B. can — High-frequency words
47. C. brush — Reading accuracy
48. A. tail — Vowel patterns
49. A. Read each word carefully and group words meaningfully — Fluency
50. D. spot — Consonant blends

Hard

1. B. slide — Advanced decoding
2. D. street — Advanced decoding
3. A. splash — Consonant patterns
4. A. thrift — Consonant patterns
5. B. dream — Vowel patterns
6. C. head — Vowel patterns
7. B. coach — Vowel patterns
8. A. shade — Vowel patterns
9. D. shirt — R-controlled vowels
10. B. burn — R-controlled vowels
11. A. napkin — Syllable types
12. D. rab-bit — Syllable division
13. B. sun-set — Syllable division
14. C. 3 — Multisyllabic words
15. B. remember — Multisyllabic words
16. B. clack — Sound manipulation
17. B. plat — Sound manipulation
18. C. clip — Sound manipulation
19. C. rain — Sound manipulation
20. C. plash — Sound manipulation
21. A. 3 — Phoneme counting
22. D. 5 — Phoneme counting
23. A. 4 — Phoneme counting

24. B. flag — Phoneme counting
25. A. street — Blending complex words
26. D. brake — Blending complex words
27. D. bread — Comparing patterns
28. D. phone — Comparing patterns
29. A. hope — Comparing patterns
30. A. rest — Decoding in context
31. C. fly — Decoding in context
32. D. ch — Decoding in context
33. A. unhappy — Word analysis
34. B. cats — Word analysis
35. D. jumped — Word analysis
36. B. The sh digraph — Fluency and decoding
37. C. The silent e makes the o long — Fluency and decoding
38. D. chief — Vowel patterns
39. D. coin — Vowel patterns
40. B. shout — Vowel patterns
41. C. brush — Consonant patterns
42. D. ring — Consonant patterns
43. D. pic-nic — Syllables
44. A. thin — Sound substitution
45. A. bed — Sound substitution
46. D. clip — Sound substitution
47. C. Look at the letters, say the sounds, and blend them — Reading unfamiliar words
48. D. crane — Phonics application
49. C. milk — Phonics application
50. D. toast — Phonics application